

SUPER JAZZ EARS!

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #101

Ear Training is a huge subject, and there are often strong declamations made about what is "absolutely required" of those of us who are wanting to be jazz musicians. Skills like an intensely keen sense of hearing, perfect pitch, absolute interval recognition and everything else can easily scare away the typical mortal who just wants to play a little blues. Dang!

It gets down to just TWO skills for our ears that will serve us incredibly well. If we have these two abilities even a little bit in place, we will not only be hearing the music better, but we will be improvising better, and we will be better bandmates for those who play with us.

- 1) Pattern Recognition - the ability to hear a pattern created with harmony and/or melody, and the ability to hear when the pattern changes.
- 2) The ability to recognize and create (ie. sing) bass lines and root motions.

#1

Exercise #1 consists of two staves of music. The first staff has four measures of slash notation, with brackets underneath labeled '1' and '1'. Above the first two measures are the chords $Bb\text{maj}7$ and $Gm7$, and above the last two measures are $Cm7$ and $F7$. The second staff also has four measures of slash notation, with brackets underneath labeled '2' and '1'. Above the first two measures are the chords $Bb7$ and $Eb7$, and above the last two measures are $Bb\text{maj}7$, $Gm7$, $Cm7$, and $F7$.

#2

Exercise #2 consists of two staves of music. The first staff has four measures of specific melodic notation, with brackets underneath labeled '1', '1', and '1'. Above the first two measures are the chords $Bb\text{maj}7$ and $Gm7$, and above the last two measures are $Cm7$ and $F7$. The second staff has four measures of specific melodic notation, with brackets underneath labeled '2' and '2'. Above the first two measures are the chords $Bb7$ and $Eb7$, and above the last two measures are $Bb\text{maj}7$, $Gm7$, $Cm7$, and $F7$.